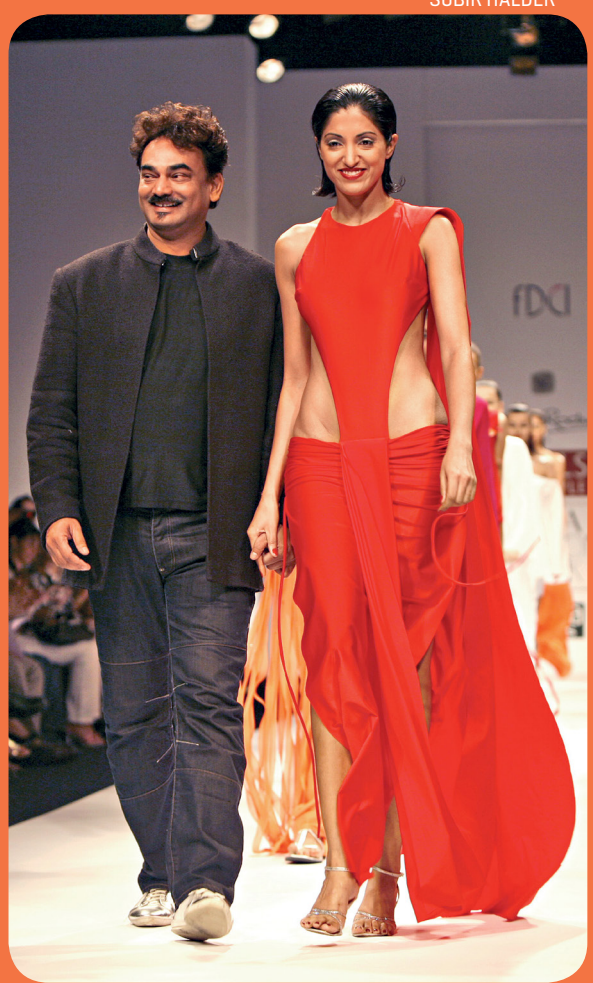
Wendell Rodricks

A man and a designer well ahead of his times, Wendell Rodricks pioneered resort wear and sustainable fashion in India way back in 1989 when he launched his label. Loose, anti-fit, flowy, draped dresses and saris in solid hues embodied the late designer's vision of comfort, silhouette and experimentation. He was the first from the country to be invited to showcase at IGEDO, Germany in 1995 as well as the first to open the Dubai Fashion Week in 2001. The Goa-based designer was also an ardent advocate of environment and LGBTQIA+ rights, and received the Padma Shri in 2014. Rodricks also launched the careers of Deepika Padukone and Anushka Sharma, who had modelled with him. He retired in 2016, and passed away in 2020.

SUBIR HALDER





Manish Arora

His high-octane, bathed-in-psychedelia, inspired-by-the-kitsch-culture couture caught the Indian fashion world by complete surprise when it first appeared under his eponymous label in 1997. Arora subsequently went on to earn the moniker of being "the John Galliano of India" and quickly grew to become a name to reckon with when he launched his second label, Fish Fry, a sportswear-styled line, in collaboration with sports footwear and clothing brand Reebok in 2001. A debut at the London Fashion Week in 2005 brought him international attention and customers, firmly etching his name in the fashion circles of the world. His works were showcased at the Victoria & Albert Museum in London in 2007. A fresh, modern way of looking at Indian design, combined with a flair for bohemian and high-energy glamour, is the hallmark of his aesthetic, as is the combination of traditional Indian embroidery, appliqué and beading on western silhouettes.